

Human Resources

Answer Booklet

Past HSC and trial questions from your Drive, screenshotted exactly as they appeared and sorted by syllabus dot point.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Section A — Multiple choice	Q1–18	18 questions	18 marks	p. 2
Section B — Short answer	Q19–45	27 questions	92 marks	p. 3
Section C — 20-mark questions	Q46–47	2 questions	40 marks	p. 18

How to use this booklet

- Question numbers match the Question Booklet exactly.
- ■ **Marking guidelines** – screenshots of the official NESA or school marking guidelines, criteria and sample answers.
- 📄 **Model answer** (yellow box) – written for this booklet wherever the paper had no answer, following the Business Studies structure (define → explain the link → apply to the business/case study).
- Mark yourself against the criteria first, then compare your answer with the sample.

Section A — Multiple choice

Q	ANSWER	WHY	SOURCE
1	D	HRM aims to maximise employee productivity and minimise workplace disputes; the other pairs are OPS/FIN/MKT goals	Newington Trial 2023 · Q3
2	C	Budgeting (finance) for acquiring staff (HR) = interdependence of finance and human resources	SIC Trial 2024 · Q1
3	A	An overseas worker paid a fee per project (not an employee) is a global contractor	Roseville Trial 2023 · Q4
4	D	An organisation representing employees to improve their conditions is a trade union	Newington Trial 2023 · Q12
5	B	Workers compensation law requires return to work plans for injured workers	2020 HSC · Q12
6	B	The Fair Work Commission approves enterprise agreements using the BOOT	Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q2
7	B	In a boom demand for labour rises, so skilled staff become scarce	Independent Trial 2024 · Q17
8	A	Working from home reflects changing work patterns = social influence	SIC Trial 2024 · Q7
9	B	Induction introduces a new employee to the business, its culture and their role	Newington Trial 2023 · Q16
10	C	Initiatives to keep staff satisfied and retained = maintenance	Roseville Trial 2024 · Q10
11	C	Resignation is initiated by the employee, so it is voluntary	2022 HSC · Q2
12	A	Autocratic leaders decide quickly without consultation, suited to a crisis	2019 HSC · Q3
13	B	Specifying the tasks and activities of a job = job design	2012 Trial (from your MC bank) · Q4
14	B	Training builds staff skills; development grows careers, helping retain experienced staff	2020 HSC · Q1
15	C	Appraisals used for organisation-wide planning (collective training needs) serve an administrative purpose	Knox Trial 2023 · Q16
16	A	Profit sharing is a cash (monetary) reward shared equally by all staff (group)	2022 HSC · Q6
17	B	Disputes escalate from negotiation to mediation, then courts and tribunals	2019 HSC · Q10
18	B	B has the lowest absenteeism, accidents and turnover and the highest output	2019 HSC · Q18

“worked out” = the source paper had no answer key, so the answer was worked out for this booklet.

Section B — Short answer

1. Role of human resource management

Q19 Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (a) **H1a · Strategic role of HRM**

2 marks

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — ABBOTSLEIGH TRIAL 2023

- a) Outline the strategic role of the human resource function. (2 marks)

Criteria	Mark
Sketches in general terms the strategic role of human resources	2 marks
Makes a general statement about the role of human resources management	1 mark

Suggested answer:

The strategic role of HR is meet the goals of the business and customer expectations. Acquire, development and maintain staff to create a positive culture.

Q20 Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (c) **H1b · Interdependence** **F1c · Interdependence**

4 marks

■ MARKING CRITERIA — ABBOTSLEIGH TRIAL 2023

- c) Using the data, analyse the interdependence between human resources management and financial management in this business. (4 marks)

Criteria	Mark
Using the data, draws out implications of the interdependence between human resources and financial management of this business	4 marks
Using the data, provides how human resources management can impact financial management AND how financial management can impact human resources management	3 marks
Using the data, gives an example of how human resources management and financial management are linked	2 marks
Sketches a link between human resources management and financial management; may make reference to the data, although unlikely not.	1 marks

🔑 **MODEL ANSWER (WRITTEN FOR THIS BOOKLET — THE MARKING GUIDELINES GIVE NO SAMPLE ANSWER)**

Interdependence means HRM and financial management rely on each other: finance provides the budget for wages, training and WHS, while HRM's effectiveness determines productivity, costs and ultimately profit.

The data shows finance **cut total HR costs by \$600 000 (from \$2.6m to \$2.0m)** and **training expenditure per employee from \$1900 to \$1500**. In the short term this lowers expenses and improves profitability. However, the HR indicators show the cost of these cuts: - **Absenteeism rose from 10 to 14 days per employee** and **strike days rose from 2 to 10**, suggesting lower morale and more disputes. This means lost production, overtime or casual replacement costs and possibly lost sales – eroding the savings finance made. - **Accidents fell (50 → 30 per 1000 employees)** and **staff turnover fell (15% → 10%)**, which reduces workers compensation premiums and recruitment and induction costs – a positive financial effect.

Overall, the data shows the two functions are interdependent: finance's decision to reduce HR spending affects employee outcomes, and those outcomes (particularly absenteeism and strikes) feed back into the business's costs, revenue and financial performance. The business needs to balance cost control with enough investment in its people to protect productivity.

 MODEL ANSWER

A business may outsource recruitment to a **contractor** (e.g. a specialist recruitment agency) because the contractor has **expertise, networks and databases of candidates** the business lacks. This means positions can be filled **faster and with better-matched candidates**, while freeing the HR department and managers to focus on core activities. It can also be **cheaper** than employing full-time recruitment staff, especially when hiring is only occasional or large numbers of staff are needed quickly.

■ **MARKING GUIDELINES — BARKER TRIAL 2024**

(a) Outline ONE disadvantage of outsourcing human resources functions.

Criteria	Marks
Sketches in general terms one disadvantage of outsourcing HR functions	2
Makes an accurate statement regarding outsourcing of HR functions	1

Sample answer:

A disadvantage of outsourcing human resource functions such as the recruitment and hiring process is that the business loses control over some of their private data and information. If this information is not managed securely by the third party it may reach competitor businesses.

2. Key influences

■ **MARKING GUIDELINES — 2020 HSC**

Question 21 (a)

Criteria	Marks
Sketches in general terms the role of ONE stakeholder who represents the interests of employees in workplace disputes	2
Provides some relevant information about ONE stakeholder who represents the interests of employees	1

Sample answer:

In a workplace dispute, employee interests are represented by trade unions. Trade unions operate for the benefit of their members and one of the services which they provide is to bargain on behalf of members in negotiations with employers.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2019 HSC

Question 23 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates a clear understanding of the differences between awards and enterprise agreements	4
• Demonstrates an understanding of the differences between awards and enterprise agreements	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of a difference between awards and enterprise agreements OR • Sketches in general terms awards and enterprise agreements	2
• Provides some relevant information about awards or enterprise agreements	1

Sample answer:

An award sets out the legally enforceable minimum terms and conditions that apply to a business or industry. Awards are handed down by Fair Work Australia. Conditions in a modern award are in addition to the minimum conditions in the National Employment Standards.

An enterprise agreement (EA) is made at the workplace level between an employer and a group of employees about terms and conditions of employment. These may be negotiated with the input of a union. An EA must pass the Better Off Overall Test (BOOT) and expires within four years.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2022 HSC

Question 22 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Sketches in general terms how minimum employment standards protect employees using examples	3
• Sketches in general terms how minimum employment standards protect employees and may provide example(s)	2
• Makes a relevant statement about minimum employment standards	1

Sample answer:

Minimum employment standards include eleven legally mandated standards that provide basic protections for all employees. The minimum standards outline basic employee rights in the workplace, regardless of the type of employment contract. For example, all full-time workers are provided with the right to four weeks annual leave and a paid day off on public holidays.

MODEL ANSWER

The purpose of **Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO)** legislation is to ensure that **all people have an equal chance to gain employment, training and promotion based on merit** – their skills, qualifications and ability – rather than being discriminated against because of characteristics such as gender, race, age, disability, religion or sexual orientation. It aims to remove barriers facing disadvantaged groups and create fair, diverse and inclusive workplaces.

MODEL ANSWER

1. **"Union membership not permitted"** – under the Fair Work Act 2009 employees have a legal right to **freedom of association**, meaning they can choose whether or not to join a union. Banning union membership is unlawful and exposes the business to legal action and penalties.

2. **"No superannuation included"** – employers are legally required to pay the **superannuation guarantee** (a percentage of ordinary earnings) into each employee's super fund. Offering a salary with no superannuation breaches this obligation.

(Other acceptable issues: the advertisement gives no details of how to apply, required skills or qualifications; a single salary figure with no information on hours, leave or other conditions under the National Employment Standards.)

MODEL ANSWER

A **recession** is a period of negative economic growth, with falling demand and rising unemployment. It affects Mango Airlines' HRM in several ways:

- **Separation** – with fewer passengers, Mango will need fewer staff. It may stand down employees, reduce hours, offer voluntary redundancies or retrench staff, which involves redundancy payments and must comply with the Fair Work Act and National Employment Standards.
- **Acquisition** – recruitment is likely to be frozen. However, higher unemployment means that when hiring resumes there will be a larger pool of skilled applicants and less pressure to increase wages.
- **Development and maintenance** – training budgets are often cut to reduce costs, and pay rises and bonuses may be frozen. Job insecurity lowers morale and worker satisfaction, and may increase disputes with unions over job losses and conditions.
- **Strategy** – HR may use more flexible arrangements (part-time, casual, job-sharing, leave without pay) or government wage subsidies to keep skilled staff so the airline can quickly recover when demand returns.

Overall, the recession forces Mango to reduce labour costs while trying to retain the skilled workforce it will need when the economy recovers.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2020 HSC

Question 21 (c)

Criteria	Marks
• Provides why AND/OR how technological influences and globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers with reference to relevant examples	4
• Provides characteristics and features of how technological influences and globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers with reference to a relevant example	3
• Sketches in general terms how technological influences AND/OR globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers with reference to an example	2
• Sketches in general terms how technological influences AND/OR globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers	1

Sample answer:

Changes in technology can influence a business's ability to create and sell its product/service. A change in technology usually allows for an increase in speed and production which generally means a reduction in time spent making the product eg Samsung uses CAD and robotics to manufacture their products which has caused their assembly based labour force to be retrenched. Globalisation, which involves increased economic integration, can also increase production and create cost saving measures. Globalisation allows businesses to benefit from lower production and labour costs found overseas which may lead to the outsourcing of jobs overseas. For example, Bonds moved their manufacturing operations offshore to take advantage of cheaper labour costs leading to Australian staff retrenchment.

🔥 MODEL ANSWER

The table shows **female participation rising strongly (44% → 62%)** while **male participation fell (78% → 71%)** between 1981 and 2021. Several social influences explain this.

- **Changing social attitudes and gender roles** – society increasingly accepts women working outside the home and in all careers, and families now expect both partners to contribute income, so more women stay in or return to the workforce.
- **Education** – women's participation in secondary and tertiary education has increased significantly, giving them the qualifications for professional careers and a stronger incentive to work.
- **Changing work patterns** – the growth of part-time, casual, flexible and remote work has made it easier to combine paid work with caring responsibilities, drawing more women (and older workers) into the workforce.
- **Living standards and the cost of living** – rising housing and living costs make dual-income households more common.
- **Support and legislation** – anti-discrimination and EEO laws, paid parental leave and more accessible childcare have reduced barriers to women working.

The **fall in male participation** reflects an **ageing population** (more men reaching retirement age), men staying in **education longer**, earlier retirement for some, and a decline in traditional male-dominated industries such as manufacturing. More men also share caring roles, sometimes working part-time or leaving the workforce.

MODEL ANSWER

Government restrictions such as lockdowns and social distancing are a **legal/political influence** that forced a rapid change in **work patterns** (a social influence) and greater reliance on **technology** (a technological influence). These have several implications for human resource management.

Positive implications - Flexible work and remote work – employees working from home save commuting time and gain a better work–life balance, which can raise worker satisfaction and reduce absenteeism and staff turnover. Businesses may also save on office costs and can recruit from a wider geographic area. - **Technology** – video conferencing, cloud systems and online training allowed communication and development to continue; HR could run recruitment interviews, induction and training online at lower cost.

Negative implications - Work health and safety – employers must still provide a safe workplace at home (ergonomic set-up, mental health), which is harder to monitor. Isolation can increase stress and reduce engagement, lowering productivity. - **Communication and culture** – it is harder to maintain teamwork and corporate culture, and managers must shift to more trust-based, results-focused **leadership styles** and **performance management**. - **Separation and job security** – businesses that could not operate (e.g. hospitality, travel) had to stand down or retrench staff, increasing disputation and requiring careful management of redundancy, government wage subsidies and employment contracts. - **Costs of change** – training staff in new technology and supplying equipment adds costs, and some employees may resist the change.

Overall, these influences forced HRM to become more flexible and technology-driven. Businesses that adapted their processes (acquisition, development, maintenance and separation) quickly were able to retain skilled staff and maintain productivity, while those that did not faced higher turnover and disputes.

MARKING GUIDELINES — INDEPENDENT TRIAL 2024

Question 24(b)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies issues and provides points for TWO benefits a business can gain from embracing corporate social responsibilities and ethical practice	4
• Identifies issues and provides points for ONE benefit a business can gain from embracing corporate social responsibility and ethical practice and identifies another	3
• Identifies issues and provides points for ONE benefit a business can gain from embracing corporate social responsibility and ethical practice • Or identifies TWO benefits	2
• Identifies ONE benefit of embracing corporate social responsibility	1

Answer may include:

- Staff retention and absenteeism rates improve as staff feel more valued and motivated.
- Business costs (such as recruitment and training) are reduced and business performance is enhanced.
- There are significant marketing and business opportunities – best practice employers enjoy regular publicity in the media, in journals and on the internet.
- Good public reputation with the community and this may attract more customers.

3. Processes of human resource management

Q33

2022 HSC · Question 22 (d)

H3a · Acquisition

H3b · Development

3 marks

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2022 HSC

Question 22 (d)

Criteria	Marks
• Provides why and/or how an induction program for new employees is important	3
• Provides characteristics and features of the induction process for new employees	2
• Makes a relevant statement about induction	1

Sample answer:

The induction process introduces new employees to the workplace. Induction can enhance employee understanding of workplace culture, policies and procedures, allowing them to make a significant contribution to the business from the outset of their employment enhancing employee competence, providing a positive attitude to the job and the business.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — REDDAM TRIAL 2024

- (c) Explain how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.

Outcome: H4.

Criteria	Marks
Provides cause and effect of how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.	3 - 4
Provides characteristics and features of how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.	1 - 2

Suggested Answers:

- **Acquisition:** a business can use this process to attract and recruit the most highly skilled employees for roles in a business. This enables a business to provide a competitive advantage through superior customer service, shorter lead times = sustainable competitive advantage.
- **Development:** by improving employee skills and knowledge, this can increase worker productively, decrease costs and enable a lower price to be charged = sustainable competitive advantage.
- **Maintenance:** is concerned with building a long – term relationship with employees using strategies such as reward management and performance appraisal can be used to increase sales through superior service = sustainable competitive advantage.
- **Separation:** is the process where an employee leaves the business, either voluntary or involuntarily. This can decrease the cost of staff and enable price to be reduced = sustainable competitive advantage.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2020 HSC

Question 21 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates a clear understanding of the difference between voluntary and involuntary separation	4
• Demonstrates an understanding of the difference between voluntary and involuntary separation	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of a difference between voluntary and involuntary separation OR • Sketches in general terms voluntary and involuntary separation	2
• Provides some relevant information about voluntary or involuntary separation	1

Sample answer:

Voluntary separation is when an employee has chosen to leave their employment of their own accord. This could be in the form of a resignation, retirement or relocation. Involuntary separation occurs when an employee is forced to leave their place of employment because they may have breached their employment conditions, finished their contract or been made redundant.

4. Strategies in human resource management

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — NEWINGTON TRIAL 2023

- (a) Identify TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business.

Criteria	Mark
▪ Recognises and names TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business	2
▪ Recognises and names ONE way that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business ▪ Recognising a feature of employee performance	1
▪ No response or factually incorrect response	0

Sample answer:

- Authoritarian style can be used when an employee needs direct supervision and when decisions need to be made quickly.
- Participative style encourages employee empowerment. Used to sharing of expertise and ideas, as well as motivation that comes from ownership of work.
- Delegative style assumes that employees can represent the business and make decisions with independence. Can affect employee performance as managers trust the ability of employees to make the right decisions.

Feedback: students did not need to specify the type of leadership style as long as it made sense logically. The better responses often did specify as they had a clearer understanding of how leadership style impacts performance. Students sometimes forgot to link the point directly to performance.

MODEL ANSWER

Job design is how a job's tasks, responsibilities and methods are organised.

- **Specific job design** – employees perform a narrow range of specialised, repetitive tasks (e.g. only handling billing enquiries). Staff quickly become experts, training is short and cheap, and output is fast and consistent, but work can become monotonous, lowering motivation.
- **General job design** – employees perform a broad range of tasks (e.g. handling any type of enquiry). It requires more training, but gives employees variety, responsibility and flexibility.

How general job design could improve performance at the call centre: multi-skilled staff can handle a customer's whole problem in one call, improving first-call resolution and customer satisfaction, and can be moved between enquiry types when call volumes change, reducing waiting times. Greater variety and responsibility (job enlargement/enrichment) also increase motivation and job satisfaction, which reduces absenteeism and staff turnover – key indicators of HR effectiveness.

(Alternatively: specific job design could improve performance by making staff experts in one area, increasing speed and accuracy and reducing training costs.)

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — NEWINGTON TRIAL 2023

(c) Discuss the strategy of internal recruitment for Raj.

Criteria	Mark
▪ Clearly identifies issues(s) and provides points for and against internal recruitment	5
▪ Identifies issues (s) and provides point for and/or against internal recruitment	4
▪ Provides characteristics and features of internal recruitment (with links to stimulus, but without discussion)	3
▪ Sketches internal recruitment in general terms	2
▪ Makes a general statement about recruitment	1

Sample answer:

Advantages of internal recruitment include:

- Incentives for staff to improve their performance
- Promotions seen as a reward for effective work
- Employee having an existing understanding of the business
- Link to stimulus provided

Disadvantages of internal recruitment include:

- Staff overlooked for the position may lose motivation
- The business may be denying itself new ideas by recruiting internally
- Link to stimulus provided

Feedback: Application to the stimulus was often quite poor. It is not enough to refer to Raj and the business alone, but rather integrate information from the stimulus into the response. For example, one argument in favour of internal recruitment is due to the nature of the software business requiring complex work that needs highly skilled and experienced staff. An internally appointed manager would understand the complex nature of the work. Responses without stimulus links found it hard to achieve beyond 3 marks. Additionally, the better responses showed a balance in the discussion (eg. Points in favour and against). Some responses only gave reasons in favour of internal recruitment for the role of managers and therefore could not achieve beyond 3 marks.

MODEL ANSWER

One strategy is **online (e-learning) and in-house training focused on developing future skills through multi-skilling**. While demand is low, Mango can train staff to perform a wider range of roles – for example cabin crew trained in customer service and ground operations, and staff trained in new health and safety (COVID) procedures and digital check-in systems.

Advantages: training can be done relatively cheaply online while staff are underutilised; multi-skilled employees give the airline flexibility to redeploy staff as demand changes, reducing the need for redundancies; and investing in staff during a difficult period improves morale, loyalty and retention, so the airline keeps skilled employees for the recovery.

Disadvantages: training still costs money when revenue is falling, and online training may be less effective for practical skills (e.g. safety drills) than on-the-job training.

On balance, focusing on future skills and multi-skilling is appropriate because it helps Mango adapt now and positions the airline to recover quickly when demand returns.

MARKING GUIDELINES — 2022 HSC

Question 22 (c)

Criteria	Marks
• Provides the ways performance appraisals are beneficial to employers	3
• Provides a way performance appraisals are beneficial to employers	2
• Makes a relevant statement about performance appraisals	1

Sample answer:

Performance appraisals can be developmental or administrative. They allow employers to provide feedback to employees about their performance and can be used to identify their training and development needs. They can also be used to reward and incentivise employees for high performance.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — REDDAM TRIAL 2023

- (b) Explain ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management.

Outcome: H5.

Criteria	Marks
Provides cause and effect of ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management.	2 - 3
Sketches in general terms ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management.	1

Answer:

- Group rewards can be used to unite employees and encourage teamwork increasing worker productivity and business profitability. Group rewards can be allocated more equitably than individual rewards, increase collaboration between team members, and incentivise group performance. Group rewards can be used to promote a more positive, cohesive corporate culture that improves workplace morale and prevents workplace disputes from arising.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — NEWINGTON TRIAL 2023

- (b) Describe the role of grievance procedures in human resource management.

Criteria	Mark
- Provides characteristics and features of the role of grievance procedures in human resource management - Uses relevant business terminology	3
- Provides general information about grievance procedures in human resource management - Uses some business terms	2
Makes a basic statement about grievance procedures and/or human resource management	1
No response or factually incorrect response	0

Sample answer:

- The rules and procedures that employees, unions and employers must follow in order to resolve a dispute.
- They provide a clear outline of the issues that are regarded as workplace grievances as well as illustrating the correct and appropriate processes to use when raising a complaint.
- Used to achieve a quick resolution of disputes.

Feedback: the better responses showed a clear understanding of what GP were. Some responses only described GP's and forgot to answer the question in terms of the role it plays (ie. Minimising and reducing).

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — KNOX TRIAL 2023

- a. Explain how HiFashion could implement TWO appropriate dispute resolution methods that would improve the current number of disputes. **4**

Criteria	Marks
Clearly relates cause and effect of TWO appropriate dispute resolution methods that HiFashion.	4
Relates cause and effect of TWO dispute resolution methods that would improve the current number of disputes.	3
Relates cause and effect of ONE dispute resolution method OR sketches in general terms TWO dispute resolution methods.	2
Limited information.	1

Answers could include:

Mediation refers to the confidential discussion of issues in a non-threatening environment in the presence of a neutral / objective third party

- Increasingly popular
- Resolving own disputes before escalation to more expensive methods of dispute resolution

Positive implications?

- Removal of bias
- The presence of a third party may lead to a more reasonable negotiation (timely resolution)
- Cost effective when compared to other dispute resolution methods - i.e. arbitration

Negotiation

Negotiation is a formal or informal discussion or bargaining process between the employee and employer

- Each party takes part in the negotiation to try to reach a compromise
- If the reason for the conflict cannot be resolved negotiations may continue to a more formal level involving unions, lawyers and employers' advocates

Positive implications?

- No legal expenses - cost effective
- Time effectiveness - increase productivity

This would assist the current level which is 25 disputes per year. Employees and the employer will feel both parties have provided input and therefore feel valued as both perspectives are considered.

Grievance procedures

- formal expression of dissatisfaction about a work situation, usually by an individual employee, but sometimes initiated by a group of employees or a union acting on their behalf
- key benefits of this method is that HF management attempts to handle grievances in such a way that they do not escalate and become more serious formal grievances
- Can quickly resolve disputes following a step-by-step documented process.

Involvement of courts

- If the disputes escalate HF may need to involve courts and tribunals to help resolve the disputes, FWC can hear disputes and appoint a conciliation member to hear both sides of the dispute and help resolve the dispute or come to an agreement. If this fail, then arbitration may be used which is legally binding outcome.

5. Effectiveness of human resource management

Q44 2021 HSC · Question 23 (a)

H5a · Effectiveness indicators

2 marks

MODEL ANSWER

Corporate culture is the shared values, beliefs and behaviours that shape how employees work and are treated. A **positive culture** – where employees feel valued, supported, trusted and rewarded – increases job satisfaction and loyalty, so fewer employees choose to leave and **staff turnover falls**. A **negative culture** (poor communication, bullying, lack of recognition) lowers morale and motivation, so employees resign and **turnover rises**, increasing recruitment and training costs.

Q45 Barker Trial 2024 · Question 24 (c)

H5a · Effectiveness indicators

5 marks

MARKING GUIDELINES — BARKER TRIAL 2024

(c) Evaluate the effectiveness of human resources management at this business.

Criteria	Marks
- Provides an accurate judgment regarding the effectiveness of HRM - Integrates indicators from the stimulus	5
- Provides some judgment regarding the effectiveness of HRM - Uses indicators from the stimulus	4
- Provides cause and effect regarding the effectiveness of HRM - Uses some of the indicators from the stimulus	3
- Provides characteristics and features of effectiveness indicators for HRM - Makes reference to the stimulus	2
- Makes an accurate statement regarding the effectiveness of HRM - May or may not make reference to the stimulus	1

Sample answer:

Human resources management at this business has been overall effective, as shown by reduced absenteeism, less disputes and greater investment in training and development. Less staff are absent from their scheduled work days and there are less disputes between employers and employees, which could be due to improved worker satisfaction. This may be a result of increased expenditure on staff training which will improve their skills, competency and confidence in their roles. However staff turnover has increased which can be disruptive and will lead to increased costs to recruit new staff.

Section C — 20-mark questions

Q46 2019 HSC · Question 25

H3a · Acquisition

H3b · Development

F4b · Working capital management

20 marks

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2019 HSC

Question 25

Criteria	Marks
- Provides detailed points for and/or against methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff - Provides detailed reasons in favour of TWO appropriate working capital management strategies - Makes effective use of the information provided, demonstrating extensive knowledge and understanding relevant to the question - Presents a sustained, logical and cohesive business report integrating relevant business terminology and concepts	17–20
- Provides points for and/or against methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff - Provides reasons in favour of TWO appropriate working capital management strategies - Makes some use of the information provided, demonstrating some knowledge and understanding relevant to the question - Presents a logical and cohesive business report using relevant business terminology and concepts	13–16
- Provides characteristics and features of the methods this business could use in acquisition and/or development of staff - Provides characteristics and features of working capital management OR reasons for ONE working capital management strategy - Includes features of a business report and uses some business terminology and concepts	9–12
- Sketches in general terms Human Resource Management - Sketches in general terms a financial strategy/strategies - May include some features of a business report and uses basic business terminology	5–8
- Provides some relevant information about Finance and/or Human Resources Management - Uses basic business terminology	1–4

Answers could include:

- Acquisition
- Development
- Job design – general or specific tasks
- Recruitment – internal or external, general or specific skills
- Training and Development – current or future skills
- Performance management – development or administration
- Cash-flow statements
- Distribution of payments, discounts for early payments, factoring
- Working capital management
 - Control of current assets – cash, receivables, inventories
 - Control of current liabilities – payables, loans, overdrafts
 - Strategies – leasing, sale and lease back.

■ MARKING GUIDELINES — 2020 HSC

Question 27

Criteria	Marks
- Makes a judgement about the human resource strategies used to achieve three indicators of effective human resource management - Applies relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues - Presents a sustained, logical and cohesive response and communicates clearly using relevant business terminology and concepts	17–20
- Makes evident the relationship between human resource strategies and three indicators of effective human resource management - Uses relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues - Presents a logical and cohesive response using relevant business terminology and concepts	13–16
- Provides characteristics and features of human resource strategies and three indicators of effective human resource management - Makes reference to case study/studies and/or contemporary business issues - Communicates using relevant business terminology and concepts	9–12
- Sketches in general terms human resource strategies and/or effective human resource management - May make reference to case study/studies and/or contemporary business issues - Communicates using some business terminology and concepts	5–8
- Makes limited reference to human resource strategies and/or effective human resource management - May identify case study/studies - Uses basic business terminology	1–4

Answers could include:*Strategies in human resource management*

- Leadership style
- Job design – general or specific tasks
- Recruitment – internal or external, general or specific skills
- Training and development – current or future skills
- Performance management – developmental or administrative
- Rewards – monetary and non-monetary, individual or group, performance pay
- Global – costs, skills, supply
- Workplace disputes
 - resolution – negotiation, mediation, grievance procedures, involvement of courts and tribunals

Effectiveness of human resource management

- Indicators
 - corporate culture
 - benchmarking key variables
 - changes in staff turnover
 - absenteeism
 - accidents
 - levels of disputation
 - worker satisfaction.